HAVING CONSIDERED, at its se venty-sixth session, amendments to the Convention, proposed and circulated in accordance with article VIII(b)(i) thereof,

1. ADOPTS, in accordance with article VIII(b)(iv) of the Convention, amendments to the Convention, the text of which is set out in the Annex to the present resolution;

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SOURCE: MSC.134(76).pdf
proposed and circulated in accordance with article VIII(b)(i) thereof,

1. ADOPTS, in accordance with article VIII(b)(iv) of the Convention, amendments to the Convention, the text of which is set out in the Annex to the present resolution;

2. DETERMINES, in accordance with article V III(b)(vi)(2)(bb) of the Convention, that the said amendments shall be deemed to have b een accepted on 1 January 2004, unless, prior to that date, more than one third of the Contracting Governments to the Convention or Contracting Governments the combined merchant fleets of wh ich constitute not less than 50% of the gross tonnage of the world's merchant fleet, have notified their objections to the amendments;

3. INVITES SOLAS Contracting Governments to note that, in accordance with article VIII(b)(vii)(2) of the Convention, the amendmen ts shall enter into force on 1 July 2004 upon their acceptance in accordance with paragraph 2 above;

4. REQUESTS the Secretary-General, in c onformity with article VIII(b)(v) of the Convention, to transmit certified copies of the present resolution and the text of the amendments

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their acceptance in accordance with paragraph 2 above;

4. REQUESTS the Secretary-General, in c onformity with article VIII(b)(v) of the Convention, to transmit certified copies of the present resolution and the text of the amendments contained in the Annex to all Contracting Governments to the Convention;

5. FURTHER REQUESTS the Secretary-General to transmit copies of this resolution and its Annex to Members of the Organization, wh ich are not Contracting Governments to the Convention.

ANNEX

AMENDMENTS TO THE INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION FOR
THE SAFETY OF LIFE AT SEA, 1974, AS AMENDED

CHAPTER II-1

CONSTRUCTION – STRUCTURE, SUBDIVISION AND STABILITY,
MACHINERY AND ELECTRICAL INSTALLATIONS

PART A-1

STRUCTURE OF SHIPS

1 The following new regulation 3-6 is added after existing regulation 3-5:

“Regulation 3-6

Access to and within spaces in the cargo area of oil tankers and bulk carriers

1 Application

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SOURCE: MSC.134(76).pdf
PART A-1

STRUCTURE OF SHIPS

1 The following new regulation 3-6 is added after existing regulation 3-5:

“Regulation 3-6

Access to and within spaces in the cargo area of oil tankers and bulk carriers

1 Application

1.1 Except as provided for in paragraph 1.2, th is regulation applies to oil tankers of 500 gross tonnage and over and bulk carriers, as defined in regulation IX/1, of 20,000 gross tonnage and over, constructed on or after 1 January 2005.

1.2 Oil tankers of 500 gross tonnage and over constructed on or after 1 October 1994 but before 1 January 2005 shall comply with the provisions of regulation II-1/12-2 adopted by resolution MSC.27(61).

2 Means of access to cargo and other spaces

2.1 Each space within the cargo area shall be provided with a permanent means of access to enable, throughout the life of a sh ip, overall and close-up inspections and thickness measurements of the ship’s structures to be carried out by the Administration, the company, as defined in regulation IX/ 1, and the ship’s personnel and others as necessary. Such means of access shall comply with the requirements of paragraph 5 and

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SOURCE: MSC.134(76).pdf

the company, as defined in regulation IX/ 1, and the ship's personnel and others as necessary. Such means of access shall comply with the requirements of paragraph 5 and with the Technical provisions for means of access for inspections, adopted by the Maritime Safety Committee by resolution MSC.133(76), as may be amended by the Organization, provided that such amendments are adopted, brought into force and take effect in accordance with the provisions of article VIII of the present Convention concerning the amendment procedures applicable to the Annex other than chapter I.

2.2 Where a permanent means of access may be susceptible to damage during normal cargo loading and unloading operations or wher e it is impracticable to fit permanent means of access, the Administration may allow, in lieu thereof, the provision of movable or portable means of access, as specified in the Technical provisions, provided that the means of attaching, rigging, suspending or supporting the portable means of access forms a permanent part of the ship's structure. A ll portable equipment shall be capable of being readily erected or deployed by ship's personnel.

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SOURCE: MSC.134(76).pdf
means of attaching, rigging, suspending or supporting the portable means of access forms a permanent part of the ship's structure. A ll portable equipment shall be capable of being readily erected or deployed by ship's personnel.

2.3 The construction and materials of all m eans of access and their attachment to the ship's structure shall be to the satisfacti on of the Administration. The means of access shall be subject to survey prior to, or in conjunction with, its use in carrying out surveys in accordance with regulation I/10.

3 Safe access to cargo holds, cargo tanks, ballast tanks and other spaces

3.1 Safe access * to cargo holds, cofferdams, ballast tanks, cargo tanks and other spaces in the cargo area shall be direct from the open deck and such as to ensure their complete inspection. Safe access * to double bottom spaces may be from a pump-room, deep cofferdam, pipe tunnel, cargo hold, doubl e hull space or similar compartment not

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SOURCE: MSC.134(76).pdf
complete inspection. Safe access * to double bottom spaces may be from a pump-room, deep cofferdam, pipe tunnel, cargo hold, doubl e hull space or similar compartment not intended for the carriage of oil or hazardous cargoes.

3.2 Tanks, and subdivisions of tanks, having a length of 35 m or more, shall be fitted with at least two access hatchways and ladders, as far apart as practicable. Tanks less than 35 m in length shall be served by at least one access hatchway and ladder. When a tank is subdivided by one or more swash bulkheads or similar obstructions which do not allow

ready means of access to the other parts of the tank, at least two hatchways and ladders shall be fitted.

3.3 Each cargo hold shall be provided with at least two means of access as far apart as practicable. In general, these accesses should be arranged diagonally, for example one access near the forward bulkhead on the port side, the other one near the aft bulkhead on the starboard side.

4 Ship structure access manual

4.1 A ship’s means of access to carry out overall and close-up inspections and

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SOURCE: MSC.134(76).pdf
access near the forward bulkhead on the port side, the other one near the aft bulkhead on the starboard side.

4 Ship structure access manual

4.1 A ship’s means of access to carry out overall and close-up inspections and
thickness measurements shall be described in a Ship structure access manual approved by the Administration, an updated copy of which sh all be kept on board. The Ship structure